

UNITED STATES FENCING

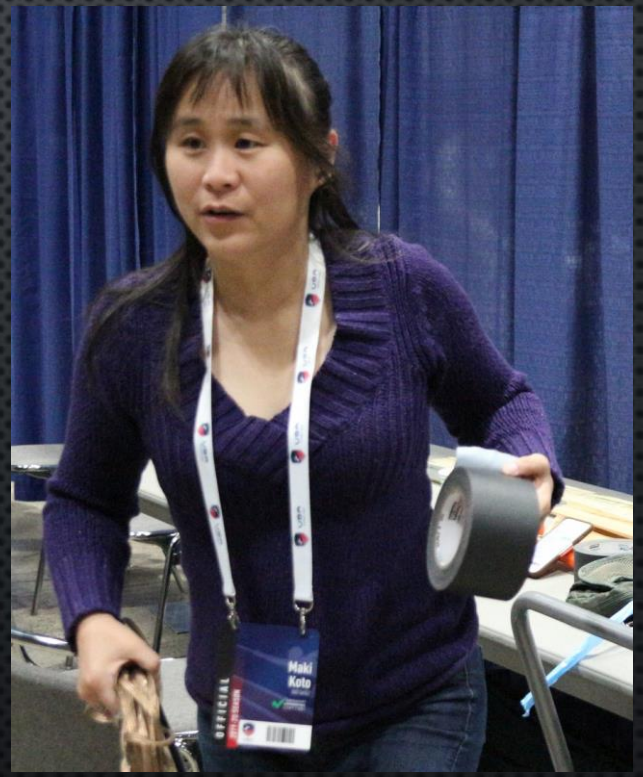
Introduction to Fencing Armoring for Parents and Beginning Fencers

By Maestro Bob Lightner

FIVE TO TEN MINUTE LONG PRESENTATIONS WITH AN OPPORTUNITY TO WRITE IN QUESTIONS TO BE ANSWERED FOLLOWING EACH PRESENTATION







WHAT IS FENCING ARMORING?

- **FENCING ARMORERS DO TWO BASIC THINGS:** WE CHECK EQUIPMENT FOR SAFETY, AND
- WE MAKE SURE ALL EQUIPMENT IS LEGAL, ACCORDING TO THE USA FENCING RULES





CATEGORIES IN ARMORING



HEAD TECHS

ARMORERS

VOLUNTEERS

TRAINEES



THERE ARE TWO FORMS OF MODERN FENCING

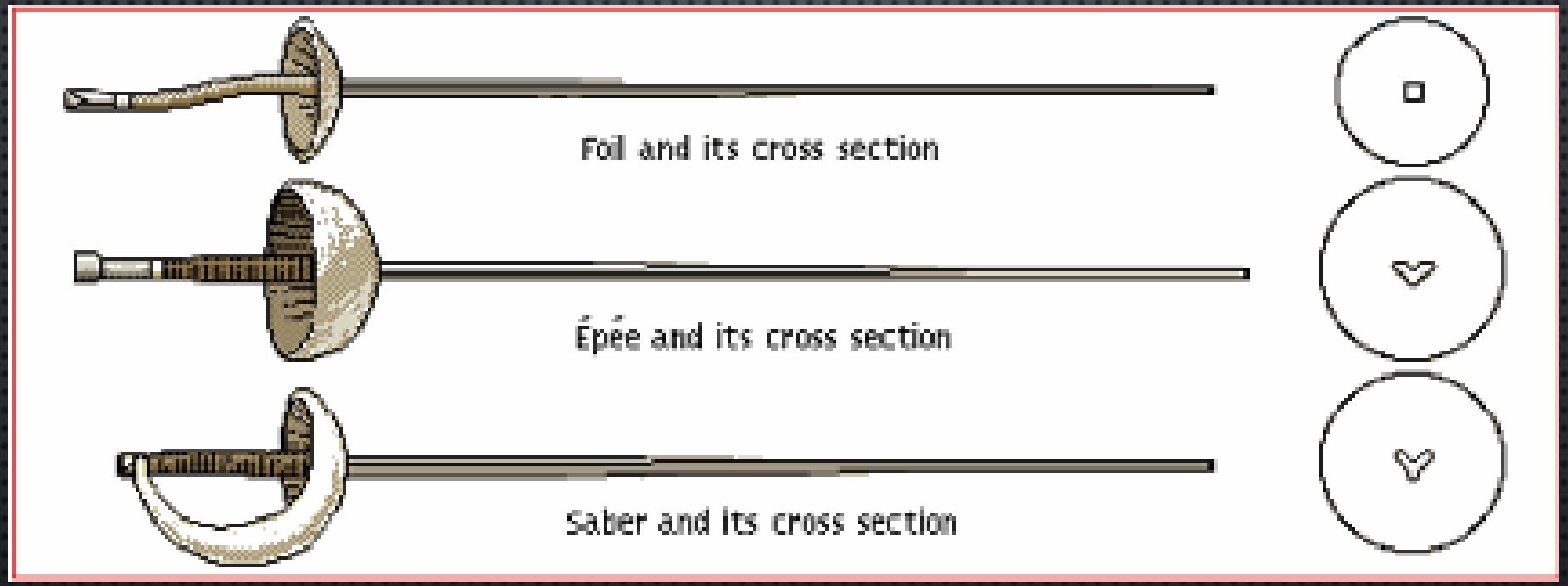


Able-body Fencing



PARA Fencing

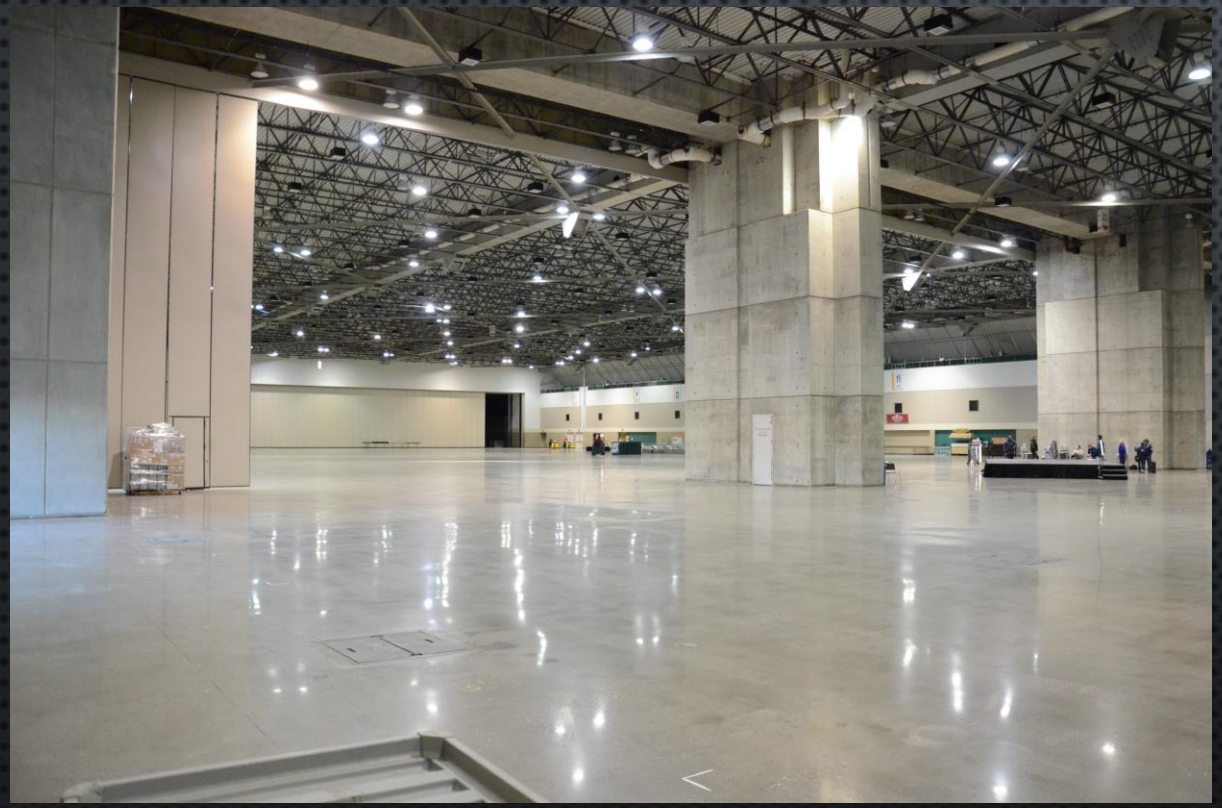
THE THREE MODERN FENCING WEAPONS



A MAJOR COMPETITION, LIKE A NORTH AMERICAN CUP (NAC), HAS SEVERAL EVENTS AND THESE TAKE PLACE OVER A NUMBER OF DAYS

Division One: Men & Women's Foil, Men & Women's Epee, Men & Women's Saber
Division Two: Men & Women's Foil, Men & Women's Epee, Men & Women's Saber
Cadet: Men & Women's Foil, Men & Women's Epee, Men & Women's Saber
PARA: Men & Women's Foil, Men & Women's Epee, Men & Women's Saber
Veterans Events
Team Events

ARMORERS USUALLY ARRIVE AT THE VENUE TWO DAYS BEFORE THE START OF A TOURNAMENT





THREE SEMI TRAILERS ARRIVE AND HAVE TO BE UNPACKED





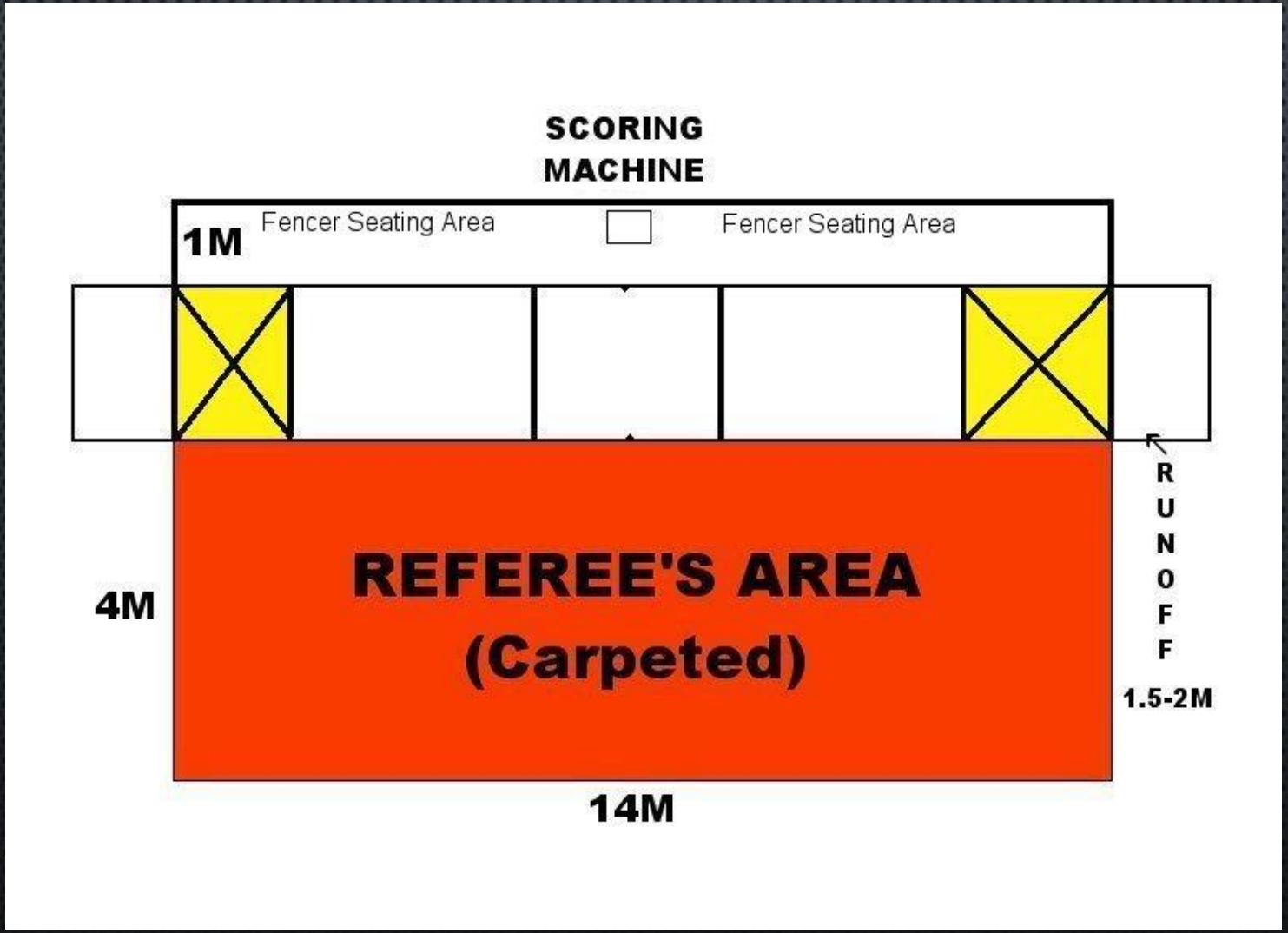


ARMORERS CHECK EACH PIECE OF SCORING EQUIPMENT THAT IS GOING TO BE USED USED IN THE COMPETITION

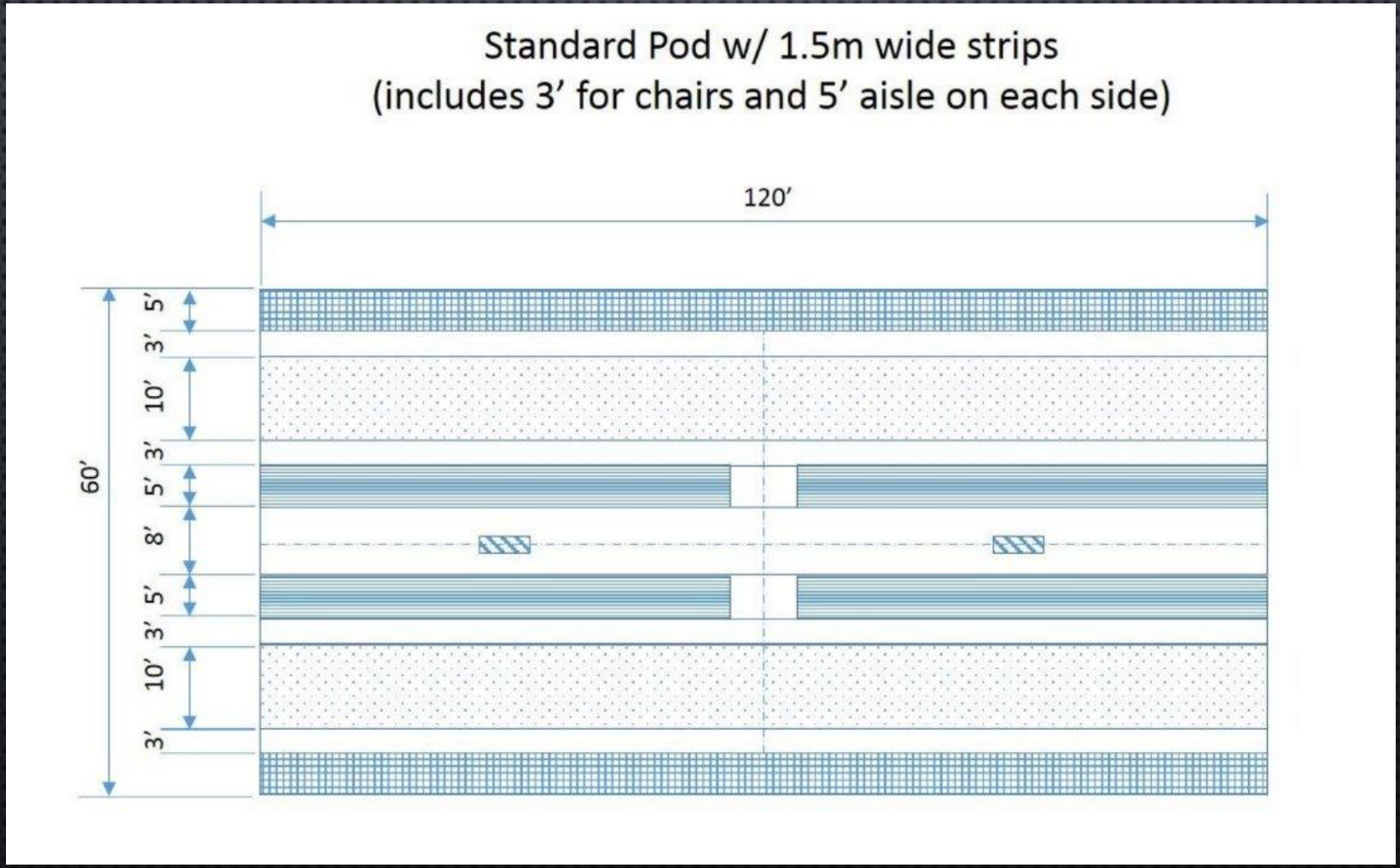




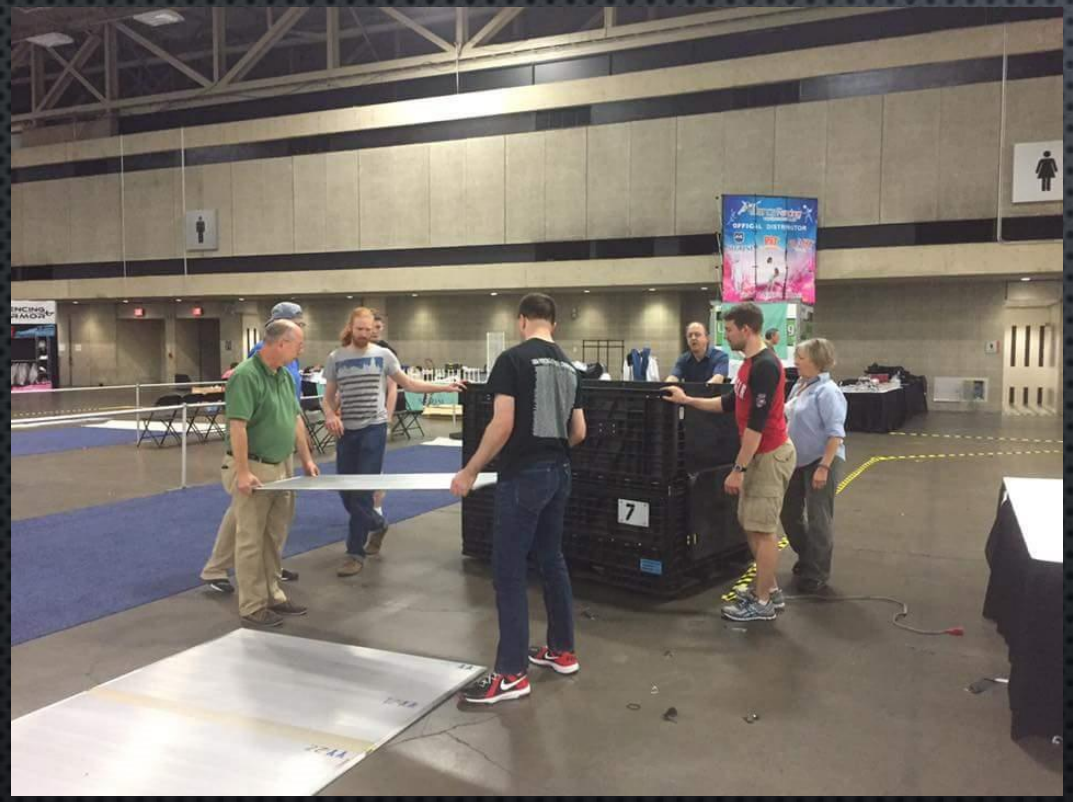
HERE IS HOW A SINGLE FENCING STRIP IS LAID-OUT



AT NACS WE SET UP THE INDIVIDUAL STRIPS IN "PODS OF 4"



EACH FENCING STRIP IS MADE UP OF PANELS THAT LOCK TOGETHER





THE FINAL "MEDAL ROUNDS" ARE FENCED ON A RAISED STRIP

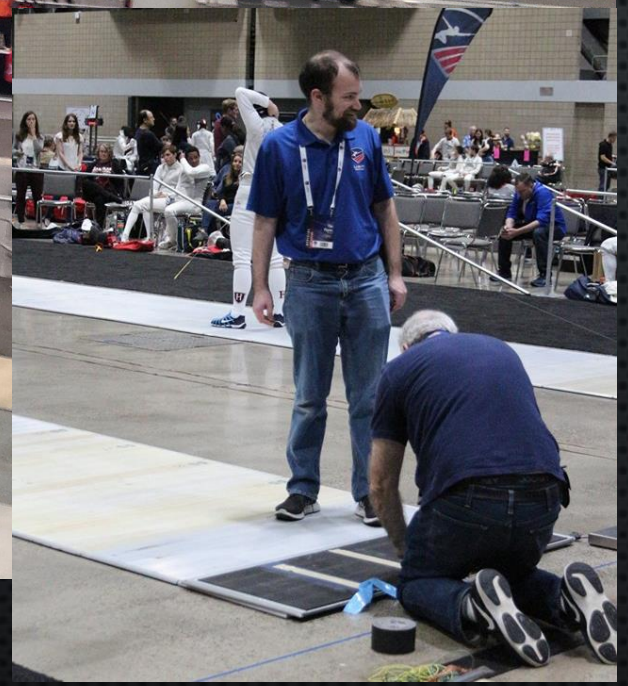


ARMORERS SET UP ALL OF THE METAL STRIPS, AND SCORING EQUIPMENT AT THE FENCING VENUE

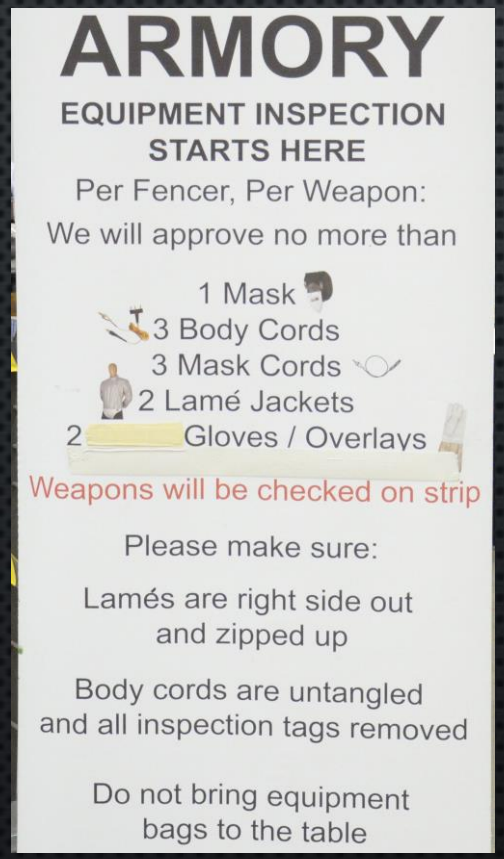


ARMORERS ALSO MAINTAIN THE STRIPS AND THE SCORING EQUIPMENT DURING THE TOURNAMENT





AFTER A FENCER CHECKS IN TO A FENCING VENUE, THEY MUST REPORT TO THE ARMORY TO HAVE THEIR PERSONAL EQUIPMENT CHECKED



- BODY CORDS
- MASK CORDS (FOIL OR SABER)
- A FENCING MASK
- GLOVE(S)
- A METALLIC JACKET (FOIL OR SABER)

ONCE EACH FENCER'S EQUIPMENT IS CHECKED THEY ARE READY TO COMPETE

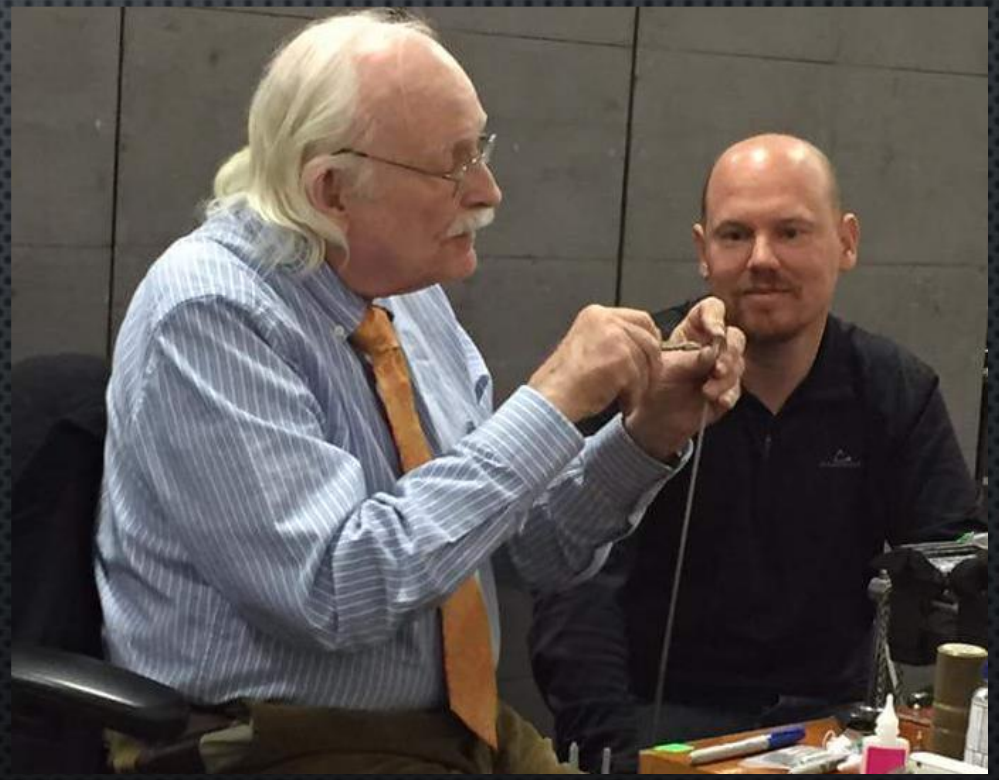






IF A FENCERS EQUIPMENT NEEDS REPAIRS ARMORERS WILL REPAIR IT, IF IT CAN BE REPAIRED





ARMORERS TEST AND PACK UP ALL OF THE EQUIPMENT AFTER THE TOURNAMENT CONCLUDES

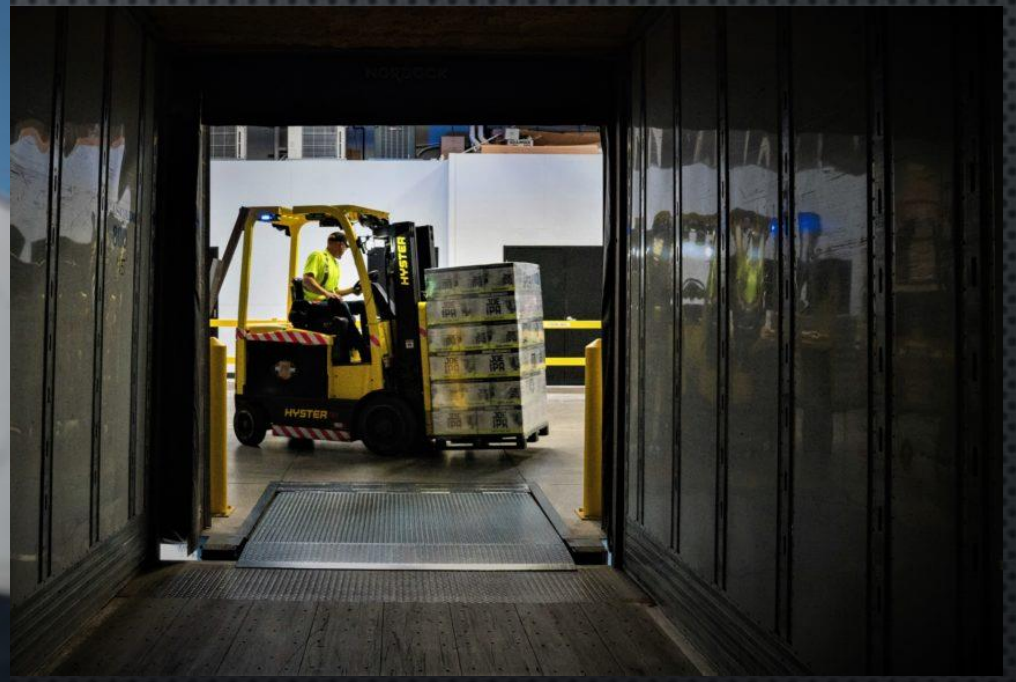




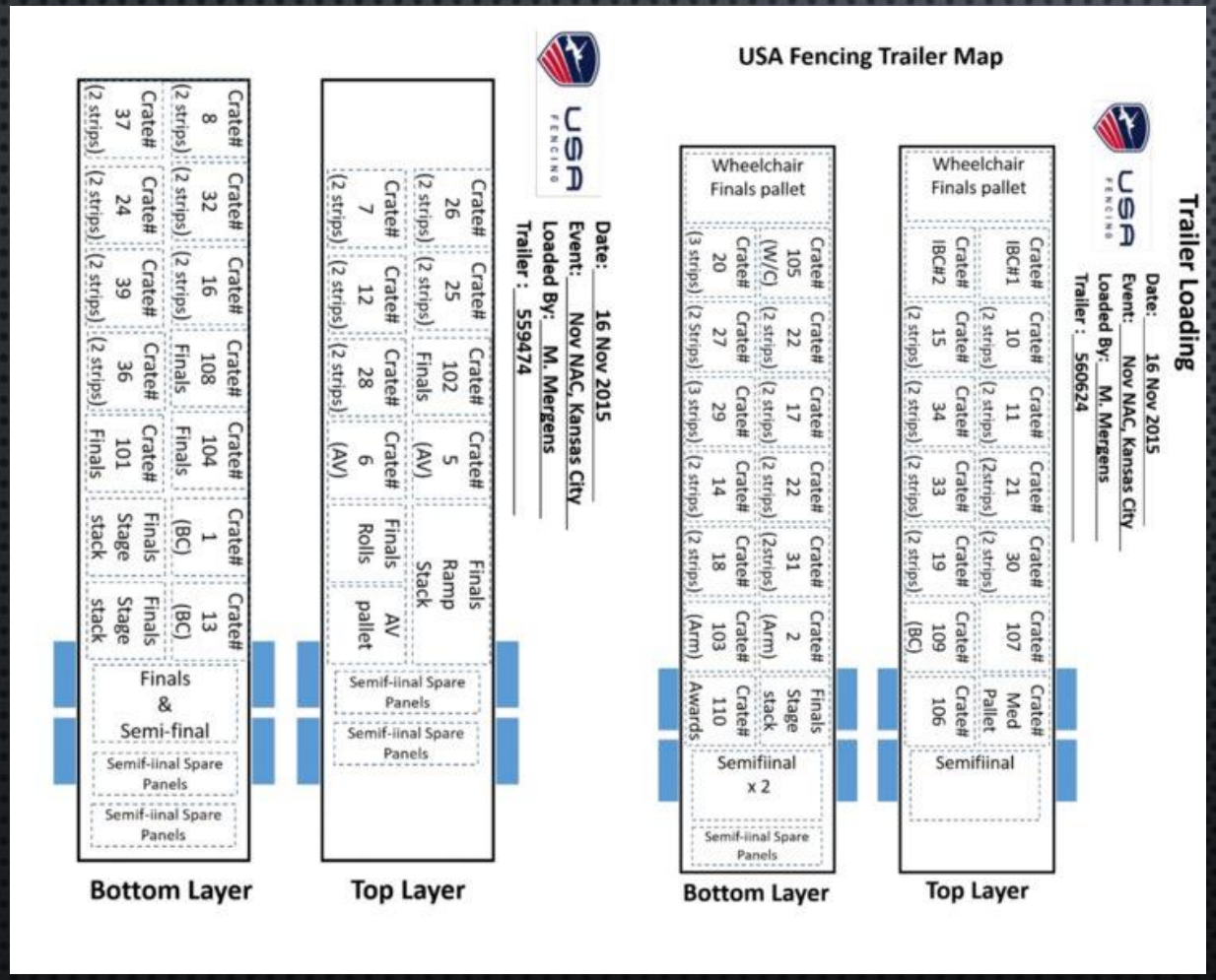


ARMORERS TEST AND PACK UP ALL OF THE EQUIPMENT AFTER THE TOURNAMENT CONCLUDES





ARMORERS TEST AND PACK UP ALL OF THE EQUIPMENT AFTER THE TOURNAMENT CONCLUDES



Two 53-foot trailer loading diagram

What skills do armorers have

- We work with tools
- We learn the Rules
- We know how to fix broken things
- We love what we do



How do you become an Armorer?

- Study and learn the Rules
- Volunteer to assist at competitions
- Get your own tools & test equipment
- Learn how to figure out why something isn't working
- Perform well at 2 competitions under 2 different head techs



THIS CONCLUDES OUR FIRST ARMORING SESSION



Send questions to:

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